APPROVED ON OCTOBER 28, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

County Administration Workshop: October 20, 2026
1:30 p.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. **Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest**

   Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. **Department Business**

   a. **Information Technology**

      1. **Communications**

Thomas Gray, Web and Public Information Coordinator, presented the communications update. He reported that the Social Media Policy, the Public Records Policy and the Strategic Communications Plan are all in implementation: the social media comments policy is being added to each County account, the updated public records policy is posted on the County website, and the revised public records request form has been distributed to departments and offices. The content calendar, now Appendix E to the Strategic Communications Plan, is in pre-production, and a monthly content meeting is being organized with the departments that have the most consistent communications needs – Public Health, Public Works and Emergency Management. Public Health website updates are in production following a planning meeting with that department, and the JOCO Alert sign-up video was filmed with Emergency Manager Nathan Sanders.

Mr. Gray stated that the Juvenile Justice data report is in final draft pending sign-off from Deputy Director Watkins, and that the AI project final report is in final draft following IT Director Ken Clever's review, with high-level security guidance being added and delivery expected by the end of the week. He also reported the first implementation meeting with JustFOIA, the vendor for the County's online public records request portal, which will provide separate workflows for the County and the Sheriff's Office. Commissioners thanked Mr. Gray for his work, noting that the structural pieces he has put in place are not visible to the public but are essential to providing services. Mr. Gray stated that with the foundation laid, the communications program should show visible growth over the next six months. No formal action was taken.

   b. **Treasurer**

      1. **Board Order No. 2026-060 – In the Matter of Temporarily Adopting Oregon State Treasury Policies Regarding the Protection of Public Funds and Third Party Vendors – Temporary adoption of OST Policies FIN 214 and FIN 216 for compliance with ORS Chapter 295 pending adoption of County-specific policies – Approval and signature**

Dustin Calvo, Chief Deputy Treasurer, presented Board Order No. 2026-060. He explained that ORS Chapter 295 requires protections for public funds that are not deposited in a County account at a qualified depository, and that funds collected by third-party payment vendors are held for two to three days before transfer to the County in accounts that are neither segregated nor collateralized as the statute requires. The statute identifies a line of credit as an alternative method of collateralization, the Oregon State Treasury's policies also allow a cash deposit or surety bond, and the Order permits other viable methods to be brought to the Board. The Order temporarily adopts OST Policies FIN 214 and FIN 216 as the County's policies, as ORS 295.098(2) permits, until a County-specific policy is developed, which Mr. Calvo estimated would take about six months with Legal Counsel's assistance.

In response to Commissioner Richardson's suggestion that the Order include a deadline for returning with the permanent policy, Mr. Calvo stated that his immediate priority is bringing the County's payment vendors, principally Point and Pay, into compliance, and that the Order gives the Treasurer authority to require collateralization or discontinue a vendor. Commissioner Richardson cautioned that the Order itself does not

shield the Treasurer or department heads from personal liability under ORS 295; Mr. Calvo responded that compliance with the OST standards and collateralization of the funds is what provides that protection. He noted that the statewide county treasurers' association, of which he is president, has taken up the issue, and that County Legal Counsel agreed the funds become public funds once a merchant receives them. The Board did not add a timeframe to the Order and encouraged Mr. Calvo to proceed as quickly as possible.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Board Order No. 2026-060, In the Matter of Temporarily Adopting Oregon State Treasury Policies Regarding the Protection of Public Funds and Third Party Vendors, and authorize the Board to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

3. **Board Business**

a. **OSU Extension Update – 4-H/Extension Service District Fall 2026 Report – Presentation**

Jamie Davis, Regional Director – Southern Region, Oregon State University Extension Service, presented the 4-H/Extension Service District Fall 2026 Report together with the Josephine County faculty and staff. She reported that the Extension office has relocated to Building V on the Rogue Community College Redwood Campus under a lease approved in the District budget, with furnishings installed the prior week and public hours beginning October 21 (8:00 a.m. to noon and 1:00 to 5:00 p.m.). Two new positions were filled following the Board's approval this summer, and the advisory council met that morning with faculty and staff and toured the space with Commissioner Richardson, the Board's liaison. Contact information for all faculty and staff serving the County was provided in the Board packet.

Frank Boothby, 4-H Youth Development and Community Relations, reported the return of the 4-H and Master Gardener programs, with about 90 youth enrolled in 4-H projects despite a late start, roughly a third of them Cloverbuds ages five to eight, and three six-week Seed to Supper sessions averaging about 30 participants each in partnership with Options for Southern Oregon and the Food Bank. Ms. Davis presented highlights for Daniela Garcia, Family and Community Health, who was absent: trained volunteers teaching food preservation and food safety, 28 pressure-canner gauges tested free of charge this year, and adult physical activity programs in development with RCC. Anne Gross, Family and Community Health Education Program Assistant, reported reaching more than 600 youth through the federally funded Expanded Food and Nutrition Education Program, including all sixth graders at North and South Middle Schools and weekly culinary classes at Gladiola High School, along with microgreen growing kits for schools and promotion of the Double Up Food Bucks program, with partnerships through WIC and DHS.

Maud Powell, Small Farms Professor of Practice, described classes, farm tours and one-on-one business consulting for small-acreage commercial and EFU landowners, assistance locating grants and loans, and fire-resiliency planning with Illinois Valley ranchers. Nan Xu, Crop and Soil Science, reported a five-session pasture management course, grower consultations and farm visits, upcoming workshops on soil testing, vegetable crop problem diagnosis and vertebrate pest management, and a vineyard cover crop trial at the Southern Oregon Research and Extension Center. Christopher Adlam, Regional Fire Specialist, described community engagement on the 4,000-acre Grayback fuels reduction project near the Oregon Caves, technical assistance to municipalities and forest collaboratives, and pile burning and prescribed fire workshops with private landowners and the Rogue Valley Prescribed Burn Association. New staff introduced themselves: Stephanie Garcia, Agriculture and Master Gardener Coordinator (September 28), who is preparing the Master Gardener training that begins in February; Cameron Johnson, Office Specialist 2 (October 1); Edilane Costa Martins, Livestock and Forages Assistant Professor of Practice (October 5); and Michael McNorvell, Forestry and Natural Resources Assistant Professor of Practice (October 12). Ms. Davis also recognized Clay Guetling, Administrative Office Manager, who supports the office remotely from Harney County.

Commissioners asked about class enrollment and data tracking, partnerships with Public Health, DHS, the Farm Bureau, local nurseries and the County's Firewise coordinator, grant sources for small farms, fuels reduction and post-fire salvage, and whether Extension can assist cannabis growers, which it cannot as an OSU-funded program, although it supports hemp. The Board asked the District to return in six months with a spring report and a budget workshop in addition to the fall report. Commissioner Richardson noted that the District's work also serves economic development and asked Ms. Davis to coordinate with Public Information

Coordinator Thomas Gray so the District's activities can be shared through the County's communications channels. No formal action was taken.

b. **Proposed revisions to Administrative Policy A-01 (County Policies) and repeal and replacement of Administrative Policy A-02 (Leadership Committee) with a Department Head Review of Proposed Policies process – Commissioner Richardson**

Commissioner Richardson presented his proposed revisions to Administrative Policy A-01 and the repeal and replacement of Administrative Policy A-02, which would replace the Leadership Committee with a written Department Head review of proposed policies. He explained that County Counsel had advised the Leadership Committee is a relatively recent creation, that in his attendance at its meetings it has not proved as effective as other methods, and that the proposal would convert it into leadership reports of the kind discussed under Department Reviews. He also questioned the current structure, under which only elected officials – who do not report to the Board – hold voting rights on a committee composed largely of appointed department heads. Commissioners also discussed the County's core values and the organizational maturity model as frameworks for building the leadership team.

Chair Smith stated that the committee had not met for about two years until he asked that it be reinstituted, that the policy makes the Board responsible for coordinating its meetings and the Board had not kept it on task, and that its stated purposes – advising the Board on personnel rules and policies and serving as labor-management consultants – remain valuable. He did not want department heads to read the proposal as a message that their input is unwanted and asked that leadership be surveyed before the policy is changed. Commissioner Martin stated that she has attended only one meeting briefly and wanted to sit through a full meeting and take a deeper look before assessing the proposal. Commissioners agreed the discussion would continue: Commissioner Richardson will bring a revised proposal back to the Board, Chair Smith will research the committee's history and seek department-head feedback with the Public Information Coordinator's help, and Commissioner Martin will return with her thoughts. No formal action was taken.

c. **Final Plat for Nolan Subdivision – Approval and signature**

The final plat for the Nolan Subdivision, located in the Illinois Valley, came before the Board without a staff presentation. Commissioner Martin stated that she had reviewed the plat but would have preferred a brief staff summary, noting that although the Board's approval is largely a formality after review by the Planning and Surveyor's Offices, a short summary would let the public understand the housing projects the Board approves, which have come at roughly one a month. Chair Smith asked that the Surveyor's Office also provide a conventional location map with each plat rather than only township and range references. Commissioners agreed the plat should not be delayed and that, going forward, the Surveyor's Office should supply a one-page executive summary and map with each final plat, which can also be shared with the public through the Public Information Coordinator's weekly update.

Commissioner Richardson moved to approve the final plat for the Nolan Subdivision and authorize the Board to sign, with an executive summary of the plat to be provided by the Surveyor's Office at the next Weekly Business Session and to serve as the template for all future final plats. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. **Potential Repeal of Josephine County Code Chapter 5.15 (Mining Ordinance)**

Commissioner Martin stated that she placed the item on the agenda expecting Legal Counsel's review of changes to the Mining Ordinance to be complete, which it was not, and noted that both the department administering the ordinance and the Mining Advisory Committee have requested changes. Chair Smith recalled that he had favored a one-year suspension because of the pending litigation. Commissioner Martin responded that the County had no mining litigation until the ordinance was adopted and the first application under it ended in court, and that she supports repeal but wants the County's new Legal Counsel, who started the prior week and received the court case materials from her the previous Friday, to review the matter first. Commissioner Richardson stated that he expects to agree the ordinance should be repealed and that pending litigation should not delay the work, since lawsuits are decided on the facts in place at the time, and suggested

preparing the repeal so it is ready for adoption when the Board chooses to act. Commissioners noted that repeal will require an ordinance, which has not yet been drafted.

Without objection, the Board tabled the matter to the November 3, 2026 Admin Workshop for further discussion.

e. **Department Reviews**

Commissioner Richardson presented the Department Report to the Board of County Commissioners form included in the packet, explaining that it formalizes the information the Board had discussed requesting from departments every six months and has been shortened from an earlier draft. He proposed that the Board subject itself to the process first by completing the form for the Board of Commissioners' Office and presenting the report at the following week's Admin Workshop, then discussing what worked and what should change before the form goes to departments. Commissioner Martin agreed, stating that leadership should not ask of others what it is unwilling to do itself, and asked that department heads also be given an opportunity to comment on the form. Without objection, the Board agreed that Commissioner Richardson will gather input from each Commissioner and present the Board's own report at the October 27, 2026 Admin Workshop.

4. **OTHER**

None heard.

5. **ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

Commissioner Richardson reported on his visit to the 4-H/Extension Service District's new office for the advisory council meeting and stated that the amount of education the District delivers to the community is large and not widely understood. He noted that the County and the District are two separate government entities governed by the same Board, that the District's work includes economic development components, and that its agricultural and forestry expertise could inform land use matters involving exclusive farm use and forest zoning. He looked forward to more of that information reaching the public through the Public Information Coordinator's work, and Commissioner Martin suggested that all three Commissioners visit the new office.

Chair Smith announced that the Oregon Department of Geology and Mineral Industries and the U.S. Geological Survey are surveying historic mine tailings in Josephine County for strategic and rare-earth minerals, and that the state geologist's team will present its work to the Board on October 30, 2026 at 10:00 a.m. in the Anne G. Basker Auditorium. He invited the other Commissioners to include anyone they consider appropriate, noted that Forestry Director Dave Streeter would be unable to attend, and stated that he had sent Congressman Bentz an outline of the County's mineral resources. He described the County's unusual geology, including one of the largest serpentine outcrops in the world, which hosts chrome, cobalt, nickel, platinum and other strategic metals.

Chair Smith adjourned the meeting at 3:20 p.m.